1 GENESIS

1 In the beginning, God created the heavens and the earth. **2** The earth 1:1-3
was formless and empty. Darkness was on the surface of the deep and
God's Spirit was hovering over the surface of the waters. **3** God said,
"Let there be light," and there was light.

4 God saw the light, and saw that it was good. God divided the light 1:4-6
from the darkness. **5** God called the light "day", and the darkness he
called "night". There was evening and there was morning, the first
day. **6** God said, "Let there be an expanse in the middle of the waters,
and let it divide the waters from the waters."

7 God made the expanse, and divided the waters which were under 1:7
the expanse from the waters which were above the expanse; and it
was so.

HEIRLOOM INSIGHTS AI-generated devotional notes

1:1 Before there was a single thing to count or name, God was already there. The Hebrew word behind "created" is bara, a making the Scriptures reserve for God alone — not reshaping what was already lying around, but calling into being what had never been. I have found this a steady place to stand when life feels formless: the beginning belongs to Someone, not to chance.

1:2 Darkness, deep water, and emptiness — and right there in the middle of it, God's Spirit hovering. The old Hebrew word for hovering is the same one Moses used of an eagle stirring over its nest in Deuteronomy 32:11. Nothing is so unfinished that the Lord will not brood over it with the tenderness of a parent.

1:3 God does not wrestle the darkness into light; He simply says the word, and light is. I have noticed that the Lord still works this way with us — He speaks, and something in a shadowed heart begins to see. Creation is, in a sense, God's first sermon.

1:4 God looked at the light and called it good before He separated it from the dark. He is not in a hurry past His own work; He pauses to enjoy it. There is a quiet lesson here for anyone who only ever inspects what they have made for flaws.

1:5 God gives the light and the dark their names — day, night — as a father might name children in his house. Then comes the first evening and morning, the rhythm that would carry every human life after it. Even the dark gets a name and a place in His ordering.

1:6 God speaks an expanse into the middle of the waters, a wide room between the deep above and the deep below. It is the sort of careful separating a woodworker does, making space where there was only flood. Order begins as a gift of room to breathe.

1:7 The waters are divided, and the text adds simply, "and it was so." No struggle, no committee, no negotiation — the word of God and the obedience of what He made. I find that phrase restful; the world is not held together by my effort.

1:8-10 [8] God called the expanse “sky”. There was evening and there was
morning, a second day. [9] God said, “Let the waters under the sky be
gathered together to one place, and let the dry land appear”; and it
was so. [10] God called the dry land “earth”, and the gathering together
of the waters he called “seas”. God saw that it was good.

1:11-13 [11] God said, “Let the earth yield grass, herbs yielding seeds, and fruit
trees bearing fruit after their kind, with their seeds in it, on the
earth”; and it was so. [12] The earth yielded grass, herbs yielding seed
after their kind, and trees bearing fruit, with their seeds in it, after
their kind; and God saw that it was good. [13] There was evening and
there was morning, a third day.

1:14-15 [14] God said, “Let there be lights in the expanse of the sky to divide the
day from the night; and let them be for signs to mark seasons, days,
and years; [15] and let them be for lights in the expanse of the sky to
give light on the earth”; and it was so.

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1:8 The expanse is named "sky," and a second day closes. Notice that God names what He makes before He fills it — sky first, then birds; sea first, then fish. He prepares a home before He brings anyone into it.

1:9 The waters under the sky are told to gather in one place so that dry land can appear. What was once all ocean becomes a shore, a place to stand. I think of how often the Lord clears a small patch of solid ground for someone who thought they were drowning.

1:10 Earth and seas are given their names, and again God sees that it is good. The land is not merely leftover space after the water was moved; it is named, and naming in this book means belonging. He is not an absent landlord of the ground beneath our feet.

1:11 Grass, herbs, and fruit trees — each with its own seed inside it. God builds the future into the thing He makes, so that life would not need a fresh miracle every spring. There is generosity in a design that keeps giving after the first gift.

1:12 The earth does exactly what it was told: grass, seed, fruit, each after its kind. The repeating phrase "after their kind" is not a cage but a family resemblance, an orchard that stays an orchard. God's world is orderly enough to be trusted and varied enough to be enjoyed.

1:13 A third evening, a third morning. The refrain is almost plain enough to skip, and yet it is the sound of a world being built steadily rather than all at once. The Lord is patient with His own work, and He is patient with us.

1:14 The lights are given a task beyond shining: to mark seasons, days, and years. Time itself is a gift hung in the sky, so that human life would have festivals to keep and planting to plan. Later Israel would set her whole calendar by these same lights.

1:15 Their purpose is stated simply — to give light on the earth. Not to be worshipped, not to be decoded for fortunes, just to shine for the sake of those below. I like that the sky's great lamps are, in the end, servants.

16 God made the two great lights: the greater light to rule the day, and 1:16-18
the lesser light to rule the night. He also made the stars. 17 God set
them in the expanse of the sky to give light to the earth, 18 and to rule
over the day and over the night, and to divide the light from the
darkness. God saw that it was good.

19 There was evening and there was morning, a fourth day. 20 God 1:19-21
said, “Let the waters abound with living creatures, and let birds fly
above the earth in the open expanse of the sky.” 21 God created the
large sea creatures and every living creature that moves, with which
the waters swarmed, after their kind, and every winged bird after its
kind. God saw that it was good.

22 God blessed them, saying, “Be fruitful, and multiply, and fill the 1:22-23
waters in the seas, and let birds multiply on the earth.” 23 There was
evening and there was morning, a fifth day.

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1:16 Two great lights are made — the greater to rule the day, the lesser to rule the night — and the stars are added almost in passing. Moses never even uses the Hebrew names for sun and moon here, only "greater" and "lesser," so that no one would mistake them for gods. The heavens are a household with lamps, not a pantheon.

1:17 God sets the lights in the expanse Himself, placing them like a lamp on a stand. They did not drift into position; they were put there, on purpose, with the earth in view. Even the far-off stars are arranged with someone's window in mind.

1:18 To rule the day and the night, to divide light from darkness — and God sees that it is good. Ruling here is not domination but keeping order, the way a night watchman keeps a street safe. The dark is not left lawless; it too has a keeper.

1:19 A fourth day closes over a sky now furnished with lights. Heaven and earth have been made, then shaped, then filled — and still no one is there to see it but God. He works faithfully even when there is no audience, which is a fair definition of character.

1:20 The waters are told to abound with living creatures, and the sky to be crossed by birds. It is the first sound of creaturely busyness in the story — swarming, fluttering, moving. God seems to delight in abundance rather than bare sufficiency.

1:21 The great sea creatures are named first, the ones an ancient sailor would have feared most, and God makes them too — then every small swimming thing and every winged bird. Nothing wild falls outside His making or His care. Even what frightens us has a Maker who called it good.

1:22 *Echo / 2026-10* Before God gives a single command to a human being, He blesses fish and birds with the words "be fruitful, and multiply." Life is meant to spill over its banks. Readers today hear an echo of that first blessing in every crowded tide pool and every spring nest — abundance is not an accident here, it is a benediction.

1:23 A fifth day ends, and the sea and air are already full. The story keeps that quiet evening-and-morning beat, as if God is going home satisfied each night. There is a restfulness in a Creator who is never behind schedule.

1:24-26 **24** God said, “Let the earth produce living creatures after their kind,
livestock, creeping things, and animals of the earth after their kind”;
and it was so. **25** God made the animals of the earth after their kind,
and the livestock after their kind, and everything that creeps on the
ground after its kind. God saw that it was good. **26** God said, “Let us
make man in our image, after our likeness: and let them have
dominion over the fish of the sea, and over the birds of the sky, and
over the livestock, and over all the earth, and over every creeping
thing that creeps on the earth.”

1:27-29 **27** God created man in his own image. In God’s image he created him;
male and female he created them. **28** God blessed them. God said to
them, “Be fruitful, multiply, fill the earth, and subdue it. Have
dominion over the fish of the sea, over the birds of the sky, and over
every living thing that moves on the earth.” **29** God said, “Behold, I
have given you every herb yielding seed, which is on the surface of all
the earth, and every tree, which bears fruit yielding seed. It will be
your food.

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1:24 Now the earth itself is told to produce living creatures — livestock, creeping things, wild animals. The ground that grew grass now grows something that breathes. God works through what He has already made, layering gift upon gift.

1:25 Animals of the field, livestock, and everything that creeps — each after its kind, and all of it good. The small unglamorous creatures are listed alongside the impressive ones. I take comfort that the Lord's eye for goodness is not limited to the magnificent.

1:26 Every other creature came at a command; this one comes after a pause — "Let us make man in our image." The plural has kept readers listening for centuries, some hearing a heavenly council, others the Trinity. What is plain is the deliberation: God stops and considers before He makes us, and then gives us a share in caring for the world.

1:27 Three times in one verse the word image lands, like a hammer driving a nail: in His own image, in God's image, male and female. This is the ground of every human dignity — not strength or usefulness, but a family likeness. The person beside you, however overlooked, carries that mark.

1:28 God blesses the man and woman and gives them work: be fruitful, fill the earth, subdue it, have dominion. Dominion here is the caretaking of a gardener, not the greed of a conqueror — they rule on behalf of the One who owns it all. It is a calling, and a heavy one, given to those just made.

1:29 The first provision is food: every seed-bearing herb and every fruit tree, given freely before anyone has asked. Notice that God does not merely permit eating; He says, "Behold, I have given you." The table is set before the need is spoken.

30 To every animal of the earth, and to every bird of the sky, and to everything that creeps on the earth, in which there is life, I have given every green herb for food;" and it was so. **31** God saw everything that he had made, and, behold, it was very good. There was evening and there was morning, a sixth day. 1:30-31

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1:30 The animals and birds and creeping things are given green herbs too, so that no living thing is left out of the provision. The same hand that made the lion feeds it. I have learned to read this as a quiet statement about the breadth of God's care.

1:31 Six times God called His work good; here, with humanity in the garden, He looks at everything and calls it very good — tov me'od, a phrase that carries the sense of delight. This is not merely adequate craftsmanship but a Father pleased with what He has made. Whatever else you believe about yourself today, the Maker's verdict over His work was joy.

2 GENESIS

2:1-3 **1** The heavens, the earth, and all their vast array were finished. **2** On the seventh day God finished his work which he had done; and he rested on the seventh day from all his work which he had done. **3** God blessed the seventh day, and made it holy, because he rested in it from all his work of creation which he had done.

2:4-6 **4** This is the history of the generations of the heavens and of the earth when they were created, in the day that Yahweh God made the earth and the heavens. **5** No plant of the field was yet in the earth, and no herb of the field had yet sprung up; for Yahweh God had not caused it to rain on the earth. There was not a man to till the ground, **6** but a mist went up from the earth, and watered the whole surface of the ground.

HEIRLOOM INSIGHTS AI-generated devotional notes

2:1 I look up from my work and see the heavens and earth complete, and I am reminded that our God is a finisher. He does not leave what He begins half-done, and that gives an old heart rest in the faithfulness of Jesus, who will also finish His work in us.

2:2 It humbles me that the Almighty, who needs nothing, chose to rest. He was not weary in the sense we are, but He graciously marked a pattern for His creatures. How kind of Him to teach us that our worth is not in how much we produce, but in belonging to Him.

2:3 God sets apart a day as holy, not to hoard it for Himself, but to bless us with it. I have learned that stopping to rest with the Lord is itself an act of trust. In a world that demands more, He invites us to cease and remember that the world is held together by Him.

2:4 Moses calls us back to remember: this is the history of the heavens and earth when Yahweh God made them. I love that He reveals Himself by name here as Yahweh God - the covenant-keeping One who made all things and who has always purposed to draw near to the ones He made.

2:5 Before the rain fell, there was no man to till the ground - so the Lord was already planning to give man a place and a calling. I see grace here: God does not wait for us to prove useful before He cares for us. He first prepares the soil, then places us in it to tend what He has made.

2:6 A gentle mist rose to water the whole ground - no thunderstorm, just tender provision. It reminds me that our God often cares for us in quiet ways we barely notice. I have learned to thank Him more for the mist than for the miracle, for both come from the same faithful hand.

2:7-9

7 Yahweh God formed man from the dust of the ground, and breathed
into his nostrils the breath of life; and man became a living soul. 8
Yahweh God planted a garden eastward, in Eden, and there he put the
man whom he had formed. 9 Out of the ground Yahweh God made
every tree to grow that is pleasant to the sight, and good for food,
including the tree of life in the middle of the garden and the tree of
the knowledge of good and evil.

2:10-12

10 A river went out of Eden to water the garden; and from there it was
parted, and became the source of four rivers. 11 The name of the first
is Pishon: it flows through the whole land of Havilah, where there is
gold; 12 and the gold of that land is good. Bdellium and onyx stone are
also there.

2:13-15

13 The name of the second river is Gihon. It is the same river that
flows through the whole land of Cush. 14 The name of the third river is
Hiddekel. This is the one which flows in front of Assyria. The fourth
river is the Euphrates. 15 Yahweh God took the man, and put him into
the garden of Eden to cultivate and keep it.

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2:7 What wonder: the God who spoke galaxies into being stoops down to form man from dust, and breathes life into him. I am made of humble earth, yet made to bear His breath. No wonder our hearts long for Him - we are only truly alive when we draw near to the One who first breathed us into being.

2:8 Yahweh God planted a garden and put the man there Himself - He delights to give His creature a place of delight. I picture an old gardener lovingly placing Adam where he would be cared for and cared for things. How like our Savior, who goes before us to prepare a place for us still.

2:9 Every tree pleasant to the sight and good for food was there, and right in the middle stood the tree of life. God gave abundantly before He gave a test. I have found that is always His way - He first fills our hands with mercy, then asks for our trust. May my heart feast on His gifts and long most for Him who is the true Tree of Life.

2:10-14 A river flowed from Eden to water the garden and parted into four - Pishon through Havilah (with gold, bdellium, onyx), Gihon through Cush, Hiddekel before Assyria, and the Euphrates. These real place-names anchor Eden in a real geography God made, not a fable. I take comfort that the God who marked those rivers also knows the rivers and roads of my own life, and still waters the places He has planted me.

2:15 The man was not placed in the garden to be served, but to serve it - to cultivate and keep it. I have learned there is great dignity in tending what God has entrusted to us, whether it is a garden, a home, or a soul. Our labor in His world, offered in faith, is never wasted in the hands of our faithful Creator.

THE ROOTED TRANSLATION

Scripture & Insights

A study edition

VOLUME 1 / GENESIS 1 TO NUMBERS 13



River at first light. AI-generated photographic illustration; an imagined landscape.

Scripture above. Heirloom Insights below.

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Scripture follows the Living Legacy Translation repository wording. Verse numbers sit lightly within the text; chapter-and-verse addresses in the outer margin help you find each passage. Full Heirloom Insights appear beneath a divider on the same page as the verse where each note begins. Range notes identify the full range they address.

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How to read this edition

The running header gives the book and verse span on the page.

Small raised verse numbers leave the Scripture easy to read. The outer margin repeats chapter-and-verse addresses for navigation.

The notes below the divider are keyed to those same verse addresses. Every active note belonging to the displayed verses is retained in full.

The companion chapter index lists the exact page for every chapter.